

1.1 Introduction to Maps

Mental World Map

Why All World Maps are Wrong

- Why are our perceptions of country/continent sizes and shapes wrong?
- What is a map projection?
- What problem is inherent with two-dimensional maps?
- Why are there different projections?
- What is the purpose of the Mercator Projection?
 - What is distorted?
- What is distorted on the Gall-Peters Projection?
- How has GPS affected traditional cartography?

The West Wing

- How can map distortions impact our perceptions of places?

Vocabulary

Physical Map:

Political Map:

Reference Map:

Thematic Map & Types:

Map Scale:

Why are maps important? Why do geographers use them?